

AJAY KUMAR PONDUGALA

Software Engineer II at Cisco | Backend & Distributed Systems

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[Portfolio](#) | [GitHub: ajaykr0905](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 2+ years of full-time experience since August 2024, plus a separate six-month Cisco internship. Focused on Java/Go services, messaging, database-backed workflows, Kubernetes, observability, and failure recovery. Maintainer-reviewed contributions merged in NATS Python and Prometheus.

SKILLS

Backend: Go, Java, Spring Boot, Python, SQL, REST APIs, asynchronous processing

Data and messaging: PostgreSQL, RabbitMQ, NATS, OpenSearch

Platform and reliability: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Linux, CI/CD, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, regression testing, incident diagnosis

EXPERIENCE

Cisco - Software Engineer II | Sep 2025 - Present | Bengaluru

- Develop and debug Go and Java backend service flows, messaging and database integrations in Kubernetes-native enterprise security systems.
- Own feature-level implementation, regression validation and cross-service defect resolution; use telemetry and release checks to separate product failures from environment issues.

Cisco - Software Engineer | Aug 2024 - Sep 2025 | Bengaluru

- Delivered Java/Spring Boot certificate-lifecycle features, REST APIs and database-backed workflows, with Python and Robot Framework validation in CI/CD.

Cisco - Software Engineering Intern | Jan 2024 - Jun 2024

- Built a QoS calculator and contributed network-validation automation. Internship is separate from full-time tenure.

ACCEPTED OPEN SOURCE

- [NATS Python #1043](#) - Preserved explicit passwords alongside signed CONNECT credentials, with regression coverage and maintainer review. Merged Oct 1, 2026 (UTC).
- [Prometheus #19882](#) - Restored active timestamps for previously firing alerts with short for durations; normal evaluation resumes firing after restart. Merged Oct 5, 2026 (UTC).

PUBLIC ENGINEERING PROJECTS

- [Distributed Scale Validation Lab](#) - Built separate Go API, transactional outbox dispatcher and workers with PostgreSQL/RabbitMQ, idempotent results and commit-before-ack. Verified crash/restart regressions and 12 single-host external-path trials (1/2/4/8 workers); 262.73-323.21 jobs/s, with raw evidence and limits.
- [Fault-Tolerant Transformer Lab](#) - Reproducible PyTorch CPU checkpoint/restart experiments with deterministic recovery tests; no GPU or production-scale claim.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

B.Tech, Computer Science Engineering - Gayatri Vidya Parishad College of Engineering; CGPA 9.3/10.

NVIDIA Certified Professional: AI Infrastructure (May 2026); NVIDIA Certified Associate: AI Infrastructure and Operations (Dec 2025).